

Steve Butterworth

Full-Stack Developer (Ruby on Rails)

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PROFILE

Full-stack developer who genuinely loves to build, which is why so much of my work has been solo: ideas turned into working software in days, then kept running in production for years. Over 30 Rails applications shipped, used by millions of users across web, mobile and even 30-metre long screens. Contracting since 2013, usually a long-term engagement run alongside shorter product builds.

Purpose pulls me: promoting green issues through my work on EnvironmentJob, and fighting the isolation of remote working through the not-for-profit co-working space I co-founded.

Happiest owning the whole loop: talking to non-technical stakeholders, getting a rough version in front of people for early sign-off, then supporting what ships. Years of hard live-event deadlines left a lasting taste for simple solutions that hold up under pressure.

SKILLS

- **Programming and build:** Ruby on Rails, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, Hotwire (Turbo/Stimulus), Tailwind, React, D3.js, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, RSpec, Git/GitHub.
- **Agentic coding:** daily use of Claude Code and Codex, driven by a suite of strict SDLC skills: task breakdown, test-first development, coding standards, and security and performance audits.
- **Prototyping and product development:** working proofs of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off; rough versions in front of users early and often; quick to pick up new tools.
- **Systems integration:** third-party APIs, live data feeds, browser automation and LLM services woven into products; a bias for the least machinery that works.
- **User focus and communication:** direct daily contact with non-technical customers and stakeholders; plain-English explanation of technical trade-offs; comfortable bridging design, product and engineering.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Rails Developer, EnvironmentJob (contract)

2013 - Present

- Work closely with the company directors to build and maintain the UK's leading environmental jobs website, along with their other web properties.
- Sole engineer across search, advertiser and job-seeker tools, admin, CRM and reporting; changes ship in days and stay in production for years.
- Introduced Elasticsearch full-text search with faceted filtering, and an email alert system sending over 150k emails a week.
- Created AI-powered import, clean-up and classification systems, and a tool monitoring new job postings across hundreds of websites.
- Carried the platform through every upgrade from Rails 1 to Rails 8.

Founder & Developer, ChangeFlow

2023 - Present

- Founded an AI-powered website monitoring and alerting SaaS, trusted by Am Law 200 law firms; shipped the first working product in weeks, solo.
- Work directly with customers to shape the product, turning requested features around in hours.
- Engineered LLM pipelines for classification, summarisation and data cleaning, plus an in-app tool-calling AI agent.
- Now a stable, lightly-maintained side product rather than a full-time venture.

Senior Rails Developer, LEX (contract)

2019 - 2023

- Built ShotView, live 3D golf shot tracking in Three.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship, BMW International Open and Indy 500, serving over 1 million visits a day within 4 months.
- Turned creative concepts into working prototypes in days to win sign-off, then grew them into finished products.
- Created the NTT DataWall, a 30-metre live data experience and the centrepiece of The Open's fan village.
- Shipped tablet and mobile apps for live brand activations, and touch-screen conference interactives including live polling and games.
- Led a small engineering team within a wider multidisciplinary team of creative directors, designers and producers.

Senior Rails Developer, GlaxoSmithKline Analytics Platform (contract, via Retechnica)

2019

- Delivered an early proof of concept in days to win stakeholder sign-off, then built out medical voice-of-customer analysis, interactive visualisation and PDF/PPT export; shipped on time and on budget, scoring 9/10 satisfaction from 50+ stakeholders.

Senior Rails Developer, Pulse Group (contract)

2013 - 2018

- Developed live event data walls and public event websites in Rails/JavaScript/D3.js for NTT DATA's sponsorship of The Open Championship.
- Delivered big live data screens for Team GB at the Olympic Games.
- Built reporting tools and touch-screen interactives for Emirates Airline.

Founder & Lead Developer, Flumes

2010 - 2013

- Founded and built a social media analytics and visualisation platform from zero: live social data collected, enriched via third-party classification APIs and made explorable through interactive visualisation.
- The platform became the technical foundation for later live-event work delivered for the likes of Cambridge University Press and Team GB.

Lead Rails Developer, AlphaSights

2008 - 2010

- First employee: set the technology direction with the founders, recruited and led the initial Rails team, and built the bespoke CRM and client portal underpinning the firm's communications.

EARLIER ROLES

- **Rails & PHP Developer, Humble Technologies** (2006 - 2008): web consultancy for UK clients.
- **Senior Software Engineer, i2 Inc. (now IBM)** (2002 - 2005): led the web version of the flagship analytics tool; built a Java/JS charting SDK.
- **Software Developer, Crystal Decisions (now SAP)** (1999 - 2001): enterprise OLAP components and a front-end JavaScript SDK; mentored new developers.

ADDITIONAL

- **Co-Founder, Unicorn Studios Ipswich** (2019 - Present): co-founded a not-for-profit community co-working space for remote workers, freelancers and contractors.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Science, 1st Class